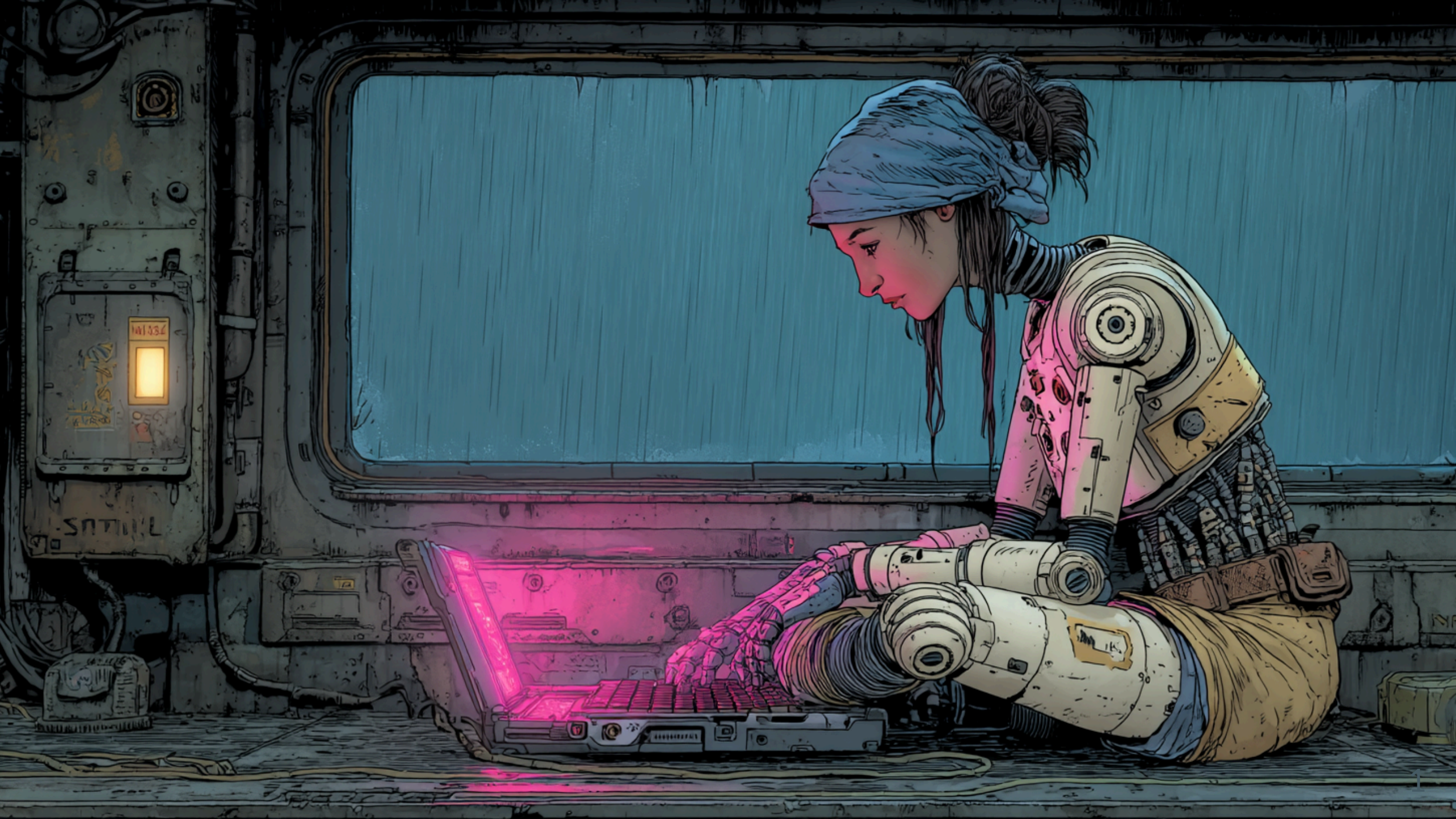




Designing at the Speed of Vibes

**Where design thinking meets vibe coding, through
the 4D AI Fluency Framework**

Playful Programming and Algorithmic Intelligence

Three loops, secretly the same loop

IDEO's design process for educators. Vibe coding. The 4D AI Fluency Framework.

Three different vocabularies, invented for three different problems — that turn out to describe the exact same underlying rhythm: **frame it, try it, judge it, own it.**

Once you see the overlap, each one makes the other two sharper.

Recap — IDEO's design process for educators

1. **Discovery** — understand the challenge, gather inspiration
2. **Interpretation** — find the story, frame the real opportunity
3. **Ideation** — generate ideas, then refine them
4. **Experimentation** — build prototypes, get them in front of people
5. **Evolution** — track what you learned, move forward

Recap — the 4D AI Fluency Framework

Delegation — deciding whether, when, and how to hand something to AI

Description — communicating clearly enough to get something useful back

Discernment — judging what comes back

Diligence — owning what you did with it, and saying so

Recap — the vibe-coding loop

Ask — describe the vibe in plain language

Run — press play, immediately

Look — does it feel right?

Adjust — say what to change, in the same plain words

Repeat until it feels done. That's the whole method.

The mapping

How the three line up

IDEO phase	4D competency	Vibe-coding move
Discovery	Delegation	Deciding this is worth building at all
Interpretation	Description	Framing the brief in one plain sentence
Ideation	Description, at volume	Trying many vibes, cheaply
Experimentation	Discernment	Ask → run → look → adjust, on repeat
Evolution	Diligence	Writing down what broke, and why

Discovery = Delegation

Before any prompt: **should this even be a thing I build?**

What's the real problem — a bored fifteen minutes, a concept nobody can picture, a classroom management headache? Delegation asks that question *before* Ideation gets to run wild.

`word-magnet-standalone` exists because someone decided a fridge-magnet haiku toy was worth building. That decision came first.

Interpretation = Description

A brief that fits in one sentence beats a brief that fits in a paragraph.

"I want it to sound like a nervous houseplant." "I want it to lie to me confidently." Not a spec — a feeling, sharp enough for the AI to build toward.

This is the same craft as writing a good exam question: role, audience, constraint, one clear ask.

Ideation = Description, at volume

Design thinking says: generate a lot of ideas before you fall in love with one.

Vibe coding makes that nearly free. Fork the sketch five times, try five word banks, five personas, five system prompts — in the time it used to take to sketch *one* idea on paper.

Cheap iteration isn't a shortcut around ideation. It **is** ideation, running at a different clock speed.

Experimentation = Discernment, in real time

A prototype isn't a claim. It's a question you're asking a room.

Every "ask, run, look, adjust" cycle is a live discernment call: *does this actually work, or does it just look finished?* Fluent output and correct output are not the same thing — the whole reason "The Lying, Confident Machine" exists.

Evolution = Diligence

The design-thinking phase everyone skips under time pressure is the one Diligence is built for: **write down what happened, including what didn't work.**

Which prompt produced the fabrication. Which fork you abandoned and why. What you'd tell a colleague picking this up cold. That record is what makes the next iteration — yours or someone else's — faster.

Why this matters for Day 3

Your design sprint is all five phases, compressed

Discovery + Interpretation — what's the classroom problem, in one sentence?

Ideation — fork a standalone, try three vibes fast

Experimentation — playtest with another table, watch them use it

Evolution — revise from their feedback, write down what broke

You're not learning a new process today. You're running one you already know, at AI speed.

A worked example

Discovery: teachers struggle to make "bias" concrete for students.

Interpretation: *"I want the model to confidently invent a stranger's biography from nothing."*

Ideation: three system-prompt variants — lie detector, vitals monitor, fire alarm.

Experimentation: run all three, watch which produces the sharpest classroom moment.

Evolution: the fire-alarm frame won — write down why, keep the other two as backups.

Try it

Pick a classroom problem. Say the vibe out loud. Fork a standalone, or open a chat window.

Discovery → Interpretation → Ideation → Experimentation → Evolution. Same loop, your subject, this afternoon.